

Ilayda B. Onder

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2024– **Texas A&M University**
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. Political Science, **The Pennsylvania State University**, 2024
Fields: International Relations, Political Methodology
Dissertation: “Cooperation, Infighting, and Diffusion in Militant Group Networks”
— Winner of the USIP-Minerva Peace and Security Scholar Fellowship
- M.A. International Relations, **Koc University**, 2018
Fellowships: TUBITAK MSc/MA Scholarship
- B.A. International Relations, **Koc University**, 2016
Fellowships: Semahat Arsel Scholar & Vehbi Koç Scholar

RESEARCH AREAS

I study political violence, rebellion, and civil war with a focus on (1) rebel-civilian ties, (2) rebel public communication, (3) multi-party conflicts, and (4) rebel intra-group politics.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

RC = Rebel-Civilian Ties | PC = Rebel Public Communication | MP = Multi-Party Conflicts | IG = Intra-Group Politics

*Indicates graduate student co-author.

- 2026 13. Kim, Yu Bin, and **Ilayda B. Onder**. “Lobbying by Rebel Groups in Civil Wars: Introducing the Rebel Lobbying Dataset, 1945-2012.” *Research & Politics*, Accepted. [doi:10.2139/ssrn.5864442](https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5864442)^{PC}
- 2026 12. **Onder, Ilayda B.** “Quantitative Premises and Challenges in Studying the Kurdish Conflict in Turkey.” *PS: Political Science & Politics*, Forthcoming. [doi:10.2139/ssrn.6264958](https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.6264958)^{RC, IG}
— Invited peer-reviewed contribution to the symposium “The Clash of Methods in Studying Ethnic Conflict: Insights from the Kurdish Case”
- 2026 11. **Onder, Ilayda B.**, and Hongbi Choi*. “Introducing the Rebel Internal Governance (RIG) Dataset.” *International Studies Quarterly* 70 (3): sqago58. [doi:10.1093/isq/sqago58](https://doi.org/10.1093/isq/sqago58)^{IG}

- 2026 10. **Onder, Ilayda B.** “A Principal-Agent Theory and Network Analysis of High-End Cooperation Among Militant Groups.” *Political Science Research and Methods*, Published online ahead of print. doi:10.1017/psrm.2026.10110^{MP, RC}
- 2026 9. Berlin, Mark, and **Ilayda B. Onder.** “Beyond Outbidding: Armed Group Responses to Transnational Jihadist Competition.” *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, Published online ahead of print. doi:10.1177/00220027261449748^{MP}
- 2026 8. Berlin, Mark, **Ilayda B. Onder**, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner. “Leadership Succession and Jihadist Beheadings.” *Journal of Global Security Studies* 11 (3): ogago19. doi:10.1093/jogss/ogago19^{IG}
- 2026 7. Amjad, Maria, Mark Berlin, Sara Daub, **Ilayda B. Onder**, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner. “Commanders of the Mujahideen: Introducing the Jihadist Leaders Dataset.” *Journal of Peace Research* 63 (2): 289–297. doi:10.1093/jopres/xjafo16^{IG}
- 2026 6. **Onder, Ilayda B.**, and Mark Berlin. “We Have Nothing to Do with It: How Statements of Denial by Armed Actors Shape Public Perceptions and Emotions.” *Political Psychology* 47 (3): e70079. doi:10.1111/pops.70079^{PC}
- 2025 5. **Onder, Ilayda B.**, Nazli Avdan, and Aaron M. Hoffman. “Credit Claims and the Survival Rates of Terrorist Organizations.” *International Interactions* 51 (6): 1050–1066. doi:10.1080/03050629.2025.2505010^{PC}
- 2025 4. **Onder, Ilayda B.** “How Civilian Loyalties Shape Rebel-led Victimization of Rebel Constituencies.” *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 69 (4): 701–730. doi:10.1177/00220027241263006^{RC}
- 2024 3. Loyle, Cyanne E., and **Ilayda B. Onder.** “The Legacies of Rebel Rule in Southeast Turkey.” *Comparative Political Studies* 57 (11): 1771–1803. doi:10.1177/00104140231204223^{RC}
- 2024 2. **Onder, Ilayda B.** “Target Hardening and Non-State Armed Groups’ Target Selection: Evidence from India.” *Terrorism and Political Violence* 36 (8): 1105–1126. doi:10.1080/09546553.2023.2252917^{MP}
- 2023 1. **Onder, Ilayda B.** “Signaling Resolve through Credit-claiming.” *International Interactions* 49 (5): 755–784. doi:10.1080/03050629.2023.2216352^{PC}
— Winner of the Raymond E. Lombra and Roberta Lombra Outstanding Graduate Research Award

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

RC = Rebel-Civilian Ties | PC = Rebel Public Communication | MP = Multi-Party Conflicts | IG = Intra-Group Politics

*Indicates graduate student co-author. **Indicates undergraduate student co-author.

R&R / Under Review / Submitted

“Performative Rebel Governance and Legibility: Evidence from Rebel Recruitment in Southeast Turkey.” Revised & resubmitted to the *American Political Science Review*.^{RC}

“Inter-Group Learning and Diffusion in Militant Alliances.” Revise & Resubmit at *Conflict Management and Peace Science*.^{MP}

“When Constituencies Unite but Recruitment Competition Divides: Cooperation and Infighting Among Armed Groups.” Under Review.^{MP, RC}

“Right-Wing Populism and Counterterrorism Preferences: The Roles of Strongman Rule, Outgroup Attitudes, and Conspiratorial Thinking in Shaping Policy Support in the United States.” (with James Piazza) Submitted.^{PC}

In Progress

“Part-Time Rebels.”
Draft in progress.^{RC}

“Kin-Soldier Martyrs and Incumbent Electoral Support in Rebel Constituencies: Evidence from Lottery-Based Conscription in Turkey.” Draft in progress.^{RC}

“Why Rebels Deny: Reactive Messaging in Civil War”
(with Mark Berlin, Fiona Bray**, Douglas Schwartz**, Katherine Willey**, and Caroline Xiao**) Draft in progress.^{PC}

“Civilian Victimization by Governance-Oriented Rebels.”
(with Hongbi Choi*) Draft in progress.^{IG, RC}

“Repression of Rebel Constituencies and Rebel Recruitment.”
(with Muge Acarlar*) Draft in progress.^{RC}

“Female Fighters and Rebel Compliance with International Humanitarian Law.”
(with Merve Keskin, Yu Bin Kim, and Blair Welsh) Draft in progress.^{PC, RC}

“Kidnapping and the Consolidation of Rebel Rule: Evidence from Iraq and Syria, 2014– 2016.”
(with Mark Berlin and Tim Jones) Draft in progress.^{RC}

“Leadership Background and Social Service Provision in Rebel Groups.”
(with Mark Berlin, Joshua Fawcett Weiner, and Muge Acarlar*) Draft in progress.^{IG, RC}

“Rebel Delegitimizing Rhetoric in Civil War.”
(with Sangyeon Kim) Draft in progress.^{PC}

“Opportunistic Rebel Violence against Civilians, How Groups Sanction It, and Foreign Public Opinion.”
(with Hongbi Choi*) Draft in progress.^{IG}

“Focusing on the Who: Rebel Governing Arrangements and International Legitimacy.”
(with Yu Bin Kim and Gidong Kim) Data analysis in progress.^{RC}

“Inter-Group Mobility in Conflict.”
(with Finn Klebe) Data collection in progress.^{MP}

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

Texas A&M University

2025 Bush School Seed Grant Program, \$11,990

2025 Glasscock Faculty Research Fellowship, \$5,000

2025 Scowcroft Faculty Research Grant Award, \$2,400

The Empirical Studies of Conflict, Princeton University

2024–25 ESOC Mentorship Program, Non-monetary

Centre for the Comparative Study of Civil War, University of York

2024 Civil War Paths Fellow, Non-monetary

USIP-Minerva Research Initiative

2023–24 Minerva Peace and Security Scholar Fellow, \$20,000

The Pennsylvania State University

2024 Lombra Outstanding Graduate Research Award, \$1,000

2020–23 Summer Graduate Research Award, \$16,000

2022 Outstanding Political Science Graduate Student, \$1,500

2021 RGSO Dissertation Support, \$2,000

2021 Program in Empirical International Relations Fellowship, Assistantship Release

2018 Jesse M. MacKnight Memorial Graduate Scholarship, \$2,000

TEACHING**Texas A&M University**

Introduction to Political Science Research (Undergraduate) Fall 2024, Fall 2025

Ethnic Conflict (Undergraduate) Spring 2026

Conflict Studies (Graduate) Fall 2026

Ph.D. Advisory and Dissertation Committees: Hongbi Choi; Muge Acarlar; Julia Reyes; Santiago Vidal Calvo; Nathaniel Williams; Hyerim Kim; Minjae Kang

The Pennsylvania State University

International Relations Theory (Undergraduate) Spring 2024

Quantitative Political Analysis (Undergraduate) Fall 2023

Graduate Methods Preceptor Fall 2021–Spring 2022

CONFERENCE, WORKSHOP, AND COLLOQUIUM PRESENTATIONS

American Political Science Association 2023, 2024, 2026 (scheduled)

International Studies Association 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026

Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop 2023

Midwest Political Science Association 2019, 2023

NYU-CESS Experimental Political Science Conference 2024

Online Peace Science Colloquium	2021
Peace Science Society (International)	2020, 2021, 2023, 2025, 2026 (scheduled)
Political Networks Online Colloquium	2023
Rabin Graduate Conference (Hebrew University of Jerusalem)	2017
Texas Triangle IR Conference	2025, 2026

INVITED TALKS AND WORKSHOPS

2025	“The Clash of Methods in Studying Ethnic Conflict.” Peace Science Conference, University of Central Florida. November 2025.
2025	“New Frontiers in Research on Terrorism and Civil Wars.” University of Houston. March 2025.
2025	“Rising Scholars Workshop.” Peace Science Conference, Washington University St. Louis. November 2023.

DATASETS

2026	“Rebel Internal Governance (RIG) Dataset” Time-variant data on 14 internal institutions and practices of 166 rebel groups across 57 countries between 1990 and 2012, capturing both written and de facto regulatory frameworks, judicial procedures, and disciplinary practices used to regulate fighter behavior. Download dataset.
2026	“Jihadist Leaders Dataset (JLD)” Data on 31 biographical attributes of 238 leaders from 110 jihadist groups across Africa, Asia, and the Middle East between 1976 and 2023, drawing on Arabic, English, French, German, Turkish, and Urdu sources. Download dataset.
2026	“Northeast Indian Militant Group Networks Dataset” Network dataset of 53 ethnonationalist militant groups active in Northeast India from 1981 through 2021, coding 8 forms of cooperation: joint operations, training, arms and funds, intelligence-sharing and logistical support, joint planning and meetings, joint public statements, umbrella organizations, and rhetorical support. Download dataset.
2025	“Civilian Victimization in the Kurdish Insurgency Dataset” 572 incidents of the PKK’s coercive acts, targeting or unintentionally harming civilian bystanders in 21 provinces in southeastern Turkey with significant Kurdish-speaking populations between 2014-2019, recording the characteristics of individuals (e.g., public worker, politician, alleged state informant, business owner). Download dataset.

“Denial and Rebuttal in Rebellion Dataset,” In development.
 Data public statements issued by rebel groups in the sub-Saharan African, Middle East and North Africa, in which they refute allegations (e.g., affiliations with other nonstate actors, the arrests of their members, the killings of their leaders, involvement in criminal activities) made by governments or media outlets.

SERVICE

Departmental Service

2026 Search Committee, Texas A&M University
 2024–26 Graduate & Curriculum Committee, Texas A&M University
 2023–24 Advisory Committee Graduate Student Representative, The Pennsylvania State University
 2019–22 Graduate Student Association of Political Science, The Pennsylvania State University

Chair/Discussant

American Political Science Association	2023, 2026 (scheduled)
International Studies Association	2025, 2026
Texas Triangle IR Conference	2026

Workshop Organizer

2024– Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop
 2023–24 Junior Scholars in International Security Workshop

Manuscript Referee

American Journal of Political Science (x2)
 American Political Science Review
 Comparative Political Studies
 Conflict Management and Peace Science (x3)
 Global Change, Peace & Security
 International Interactions
 International Studies Quarterly (x3)
 Journal of Conflict Resolution
 Journal of Experimental Political Science
 Journal of Global Security Studies
 Journal of Peace Research (x3)
 Journal of Politics
 Network Science (x2)
 Political Science Research and Methods
 Security Journal
 Security Studies

Book Proposal Referee

Palgrave Macmillan
 Routledge

Grant Proposal Referee

APSA Centennial Center Research Grants

MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association

International Studies Association

Peace Science Society (International)

Updated September 14, 2026